

floor. Let two or three people in on the joke (except the victims of course), and watch as they are bewildered about the strange things happening on their monitors, as the other moves the mouse or types something. This can also be done if you're one of the two, where you control the other's mouse or keyboard.

Sounds

Windows XP's sounds reside in the C:\Windows\Media folder. These include the Startup and Shutdown sounds, and all the other short sounds you hear when running Windows. You can also do this with instant messengers, especially for the people who love to IM at work!

Replace a particular sound with something loud! Popular choices in the past have been explosions, machine guns and even adult movie soundtracks! If it's the Startup sound you're modifying, make sure you turn up the volume on your victim's speakers. Just rename the original sound, place your sound in the \Windows\Media directory and rename your sound file to the same name as the original. You can also do this by going to Control Panel > Sounds and Audio Devices, and clicking on the Sounds tab. Select an action, and in the Sounds dropdown below, you can select the sound you want, play it, or click "Browse..." to add your own sound. You can get some funny WAV files from http://www.thefreesite.com/Free_Sounds/Free_WAVs/.

Sit back and watch as your chosen sound scares or embarrasses your victim.

Word Fun

You have to love Microsoft Word's AutoCorrect! This can help you place a nice prank on a co-worker. If you're not the subtle type, you can set Word to replace a common word like "the" with something else. It can be as different as "virus," "you idiot," "_INSERT_ARTICLE_", "help, this guy can't spell," or as subtle as "teh" or "them." If the victim is not too computer-savvy, he/she may never even figure it out.

You can find Microsoft Word's AutoCorrect feature by going to Tools > AutoCorrect Options... In the Replace box type the word you want to replace, and in the With box, type in your prank word, and then Click Add, then OK.

Note: If you're using Office 2007 Beta, use [Alt] + [T] + [A] to get to AutoCorrect Options, or click on the Office 2007 logo > Word Options > Proofing, and you will see an AutoCorrect Options button on the right.

Mouse Grouse

There are a couple of things that involve a mouse that you can do to people. If you're an extremist, you could use the "real-mouse-on-a-string" joke as depicted on the previous page, but your bosses might not take kindly to you bringing rodents into work! If you just have to, use a realistic-looking stuffed toy.

Apart from this, if your colleague uses an older ball mouse, you can open it up and stick the ball to the body using tape. This will cause the mouse to stop responding, or, at least, slow it down like mad.

You could also play with the mouse sensitivity settings in Windows XP, and make it either too fast or too slow to manage, which will frustrate your colleague even more.

Last but not least, you can just switch the mouse configuration over from right-handed to left-handed, and watch with glee as your colleague desperately tries to left click on something and ends up getting the right-click menu!

You can get access to all the mouse software tweaks by going to Control Panel > Mouse. Again, this only works if your colleague is not too well-versed with PCs and the way they work.

The Hung Desktop Trick

This one is old, and will only fool absolute novices, so make sure your victim has just started using computers, or else it's just a waste of time.

Basically, it involves taking a snapshot of your victim's desktop environment, then using it as the desktop wallpaper, and hiding all other icons. This makes it seem like they're on their desktop, but nothing is clickable, and thus the confusion.

Press [Print Screen], open MS Paint, and press [Ctrl] + [V] to paste the copied image. Then save it as a BMP file somewhere on your computer. Now right-click on the desktop and go to Properties > Desktop, click on Browse..., and then choose the picture you just saved. Then right-click on the Desktop, go to Arrange Icons By > Show Desktop Icons (un-check it). This

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